



Noteable Summer 2026 Updates

Guidance for teaching staff and course teams

Academic Year 2026–27

Noteable has been updated for Academic Year 2026/27. This guide explains the main changes and what course teams should do before teaching begins.

Detailed guidance for VLE administrators, coding agents and assignment workflows is available separately.

Call to action: what course teams need to do

Before teaching begins, teaching staff should:

1. **Test teaching materials** in the Noteable environment that students will use.
2. **Check required packages and imports** are available.
3. **Run notebooks from start to finish** and confirm outputs remain as expected.
4. **Test assessment workflows** where Noteable and nbgrader are used for coursework.
5. **Check VLE course links**, including any deep links to a specific notebook environment.
6. Report issues through the [Noteable contact form open in new](#).

For current environments, packages and extensions, see the [Noteable notebook descriptions](#).

What is new in the Summer 2026 updates

The Summer 2026 update includes:

- refreshed notebook environments and package versions;
- access to supported AI coding agents.
- support for VLE deep links to a selected notebook environment, where configured locally;
- new instructor tools for assignment workflows;
- clearer startup information while notebook servers launch;
- VS Code available from supported JupyterLab environments;
- updated Noteable menu links;

Short announcement for mailing lists or VLE posts

Please feel free to use the text below when communicating with users at your institution

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Subject: Noteable updated for AY 2026/27 testing

Noteable has been updated ahead of Academic Year 2026/27. These updates are now available for users.

Creating a deep link in Moodle: select the required Noteable environment when adding the course activity, then save and test the link. This update includes refreshed notebook environments, Codex, Claude and OpenCode coding agents, a clearer launch experience, VS Code in all JupyterLab-based environments, and adds new tools for instructors to support assignment workflows.

Staff are encouraged to test planned teaching materials, notebooks, packages and assessment workflows in Noteable ahead of the start of the academic year.

If you do not have access to the relevant Noteable environment, or are unsure how to access it, please contact your local Learning Technology team. For site representatives, the VLE administrator responsible for the staging environment is the appropriate point of contact to enable access to Noteable Beta for testing.

Notebook environment details are available at:

<https://noteable.edina.ac.uk/notebook-descriptions>

Please report any issues through the Noteable contact form:

<https://noteable.edina.ac.uk/contact-us/>

The Noteable product team appreciates your feedback and testing ahead of the new academic year.

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1. Refreshed notebook environments

Notebook environments have been refreshed for AY 2026/27, including updated package versions, kernels and extensions.

Course teams should test their materials before teaching begins, particularly where notebooks rely on particular package versions, integrations or assessment workflows.

Standard Python 3

Standard Python 3 remains the recommended general-purpose environment for Python teaching.

It includes JupyterLab, Notebook, common Python packages for data science and visualisation, and VS Code access from the JupyterLab launcher.

Use Standard Python 3 unless your course requires a specialist or language-specific environment.

Specialist notebook environments

Subject-specific environments remain available where their package sets are required:

- Astronomy Notebook
- BioChemistry Notebook
- GeoScience Notebook
- Language and Machine Learning Notebook
- SageMath

These environments have also been refreshed. Course teams should test planned notebooks and packages in the relevant environment.

RStudio

Use **RStudio** for:

- R projects;
- R scripts;
- R Markdown files;
- workflows requiring the RStudio IDE.

The refreshed RStudio environment includes updated R packages.

R with Stan

Use **R with Stan** where R is required in a JupyterLab notebook.

This environment provides an R kernel within JupyterLab.

Important: Use RStudio for R Markdown. VS Code in the R with Stan environment does not support R-based .ipynb notebooks or R Markdown workflows.

2. Clearer launch experience and updated UI options

The Noteable launch page now provides more information while a notebook server is starting.

It shows:

- the course code;
- the institution name;
- notebook-server startup status.

This should make it clearer what is happening while a server launches. No action is required.

Updated Noteable menu

The Noteable menu includes:

- Help and Guides
- FAQs
- Clear trash

The Clear trash option permanently removes items from a user's trash folder. Users should use this where deleted files are no longer needed.

3. VS Code in JupyterLab

VS Code is now available from the JupyterLab launcher in supported JupyterLab-based Noteable environments.

There is no longer a separate VS Code environment on the Noteable launcher.

VS Code can be used for:

- editing code and files;
- formatting and linting;
- working on larger coding projects;
- editing and running Python .ipynb notebooks.

R users: RStudio remains the recommended option for R scripts, projects and R Markdown files.

4. VLE deep linking

What is deep linking?

Where it has been configured with the institution's VLE, a Noteable course link can launch directly into a selected notebook environment.

For example, a course may launch students directly into:

- Standard Python 3;
- RStudio;
- BioChemistry Notebook;
- GeoScience Notebook;
- Language and Machine Learning Notebook.

This avoids requiring students to choose an environment from the standard Noteable launcher.

When to use Deep Linking

Deep linking is recommended where a course requires one specific notebook environment. It can:

- reduce the risk of students selecting the wrong environment;
- ensure staff and students use the expected setup;
- simplify course instructions;

- provide a more consistent launch experience.

Use a standard Noteable launcher link instead where students need to choose between different environments.

5. Assignment workflow tools

Two updated instructor tools are available for courses using the Noteable assignment exchange service:

- **Exchange History**
- **Bulk Autograding**

Exchange History

Exchange History provides a record of course activity in the assignment exchange service. It can help instructors check releases, submissions, collection activity and feedback workflows.

Examples include checking whether:

- an assignment has been released;
- a student submission is present in the exchange;
- a submission can be collected or downloaded again;
- feedback activity has taken place.

Bulk Autograding

Bulk Autograding provides an interface for collecting and autograding submissions for the current course.

It shows:

- the number of submissions available in the exchange;
- the number of submissions already collected locally;
- options to collect outstanding submissions and run bulk autograding.

It is designed to be more resilient than a standard workflow where an individual submission causes an error, allowing other submissions to continue where possible.

For detailed instructions, see **Noteable Assignment Workflow Updates – Guidance for AY 2026/27**

6. AI-assisted coding and coding agents

Supported Noteable environments provide access to AI-assisted coding tools.

Coding agents available in supported environments include:

- Codex;
- Claude;
- OpenCode.

These tools can support code generation, debugging, explanation and notebook-development workflows. They are available from the command line in supported environments.

Coding-agent features may change during the academic year, separately from the annual notebook-image refresh.

Before using coding agents in teaching: Course teams should consider API-key requirements, student access, cost, assessment design and relevant institutional guidance.

For detailed information, see **Coding Agents in Noteable – Guidance for AY 2026/27**

Further information

- [Noteable notebook descriptions](#)
- **Coding Agents in Noteable – Guidance for AY 2026/27**
- **Noteable Assignment Workflow Updates – Guidance for AY 2026/27**
- [Noteable contact form](#)

Reporting issues

If you encounter any issues following the summer updates, please report them using the Noteable contact form: <https://noteable.edina.ac.uk/contact-us/> .

Include:

- your University username;
- the Noteable environment used;
- the course or test area used to access Noteable;
- the notebook, package or feature affected;
- steps to reproduce the issue;
- screenshots or error messages;
- the expected and actual behaviour;
- whether the issue affects teaching, assessment or general use.

Appendix: Additional Information and Setup Guidance

This appendix provides supporting detail for course teams, site representatives and VLE administrators

Appendix A: VLE deep-linking setup

Who should use this section?

This section is for:

- VLE administrators;
- Noteable site representatives;
- Learning Technology teams;
- instructors who have been advised that deep linking is enabled at their institution.

Course teams should first confirm with their local VLE administrator or Learning Technology team that Noteable deep linking has been configured and is available.

Important: Deep linking requires local VLE/LTI configuration before instructors can create course links to specific Noteable environments.

A.1 Typical instructor workflow

The precise names of options will vary between VLEs, but the usual workflow is:

1. Add the Noteable LTI deep linking tool to the relevant course area.
2. Select **Select content**, **Choose content**, or the equivalent option in the VLE.
3. Choose the required Noteable environment.
4. Enter a clear activity name.
5. Save the activity.
6. Test the activity from the course area.

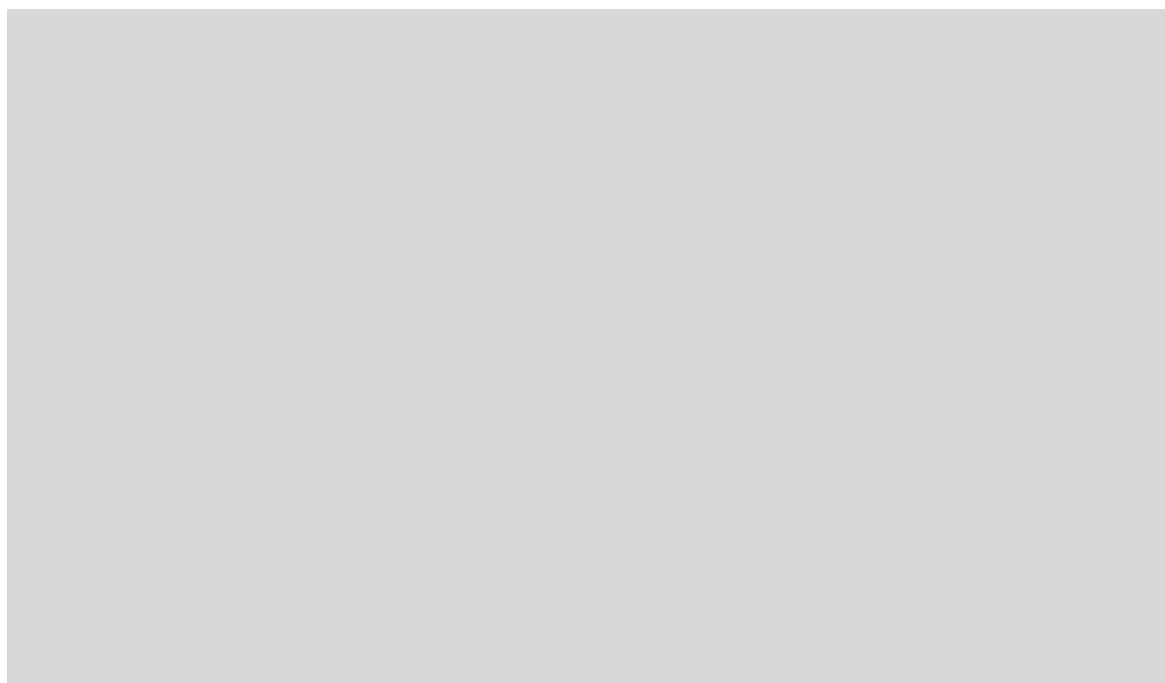
Recommended activity names include:

- **Noteable: Standard Python 3**
- **RStudio notebook in Noteable**
- **Noteable: BioChemistry Notebook**
- **Introduction to Biochemistry: Noteable**
- **Data Analysis Practical: Noteable**

Avoid general labels such as simply **Noteable** where deep linking launches directly into a particular environment.

Where your VLE provides the option, configure Noteable LTI links to open in a new browser tab or window, rather than inside the VLE frame.

This provides a clearer and more reliable experience for users.



Creating a deep link in Moodle: select the required Noteable environment when adding the course activity, then save and test the link.

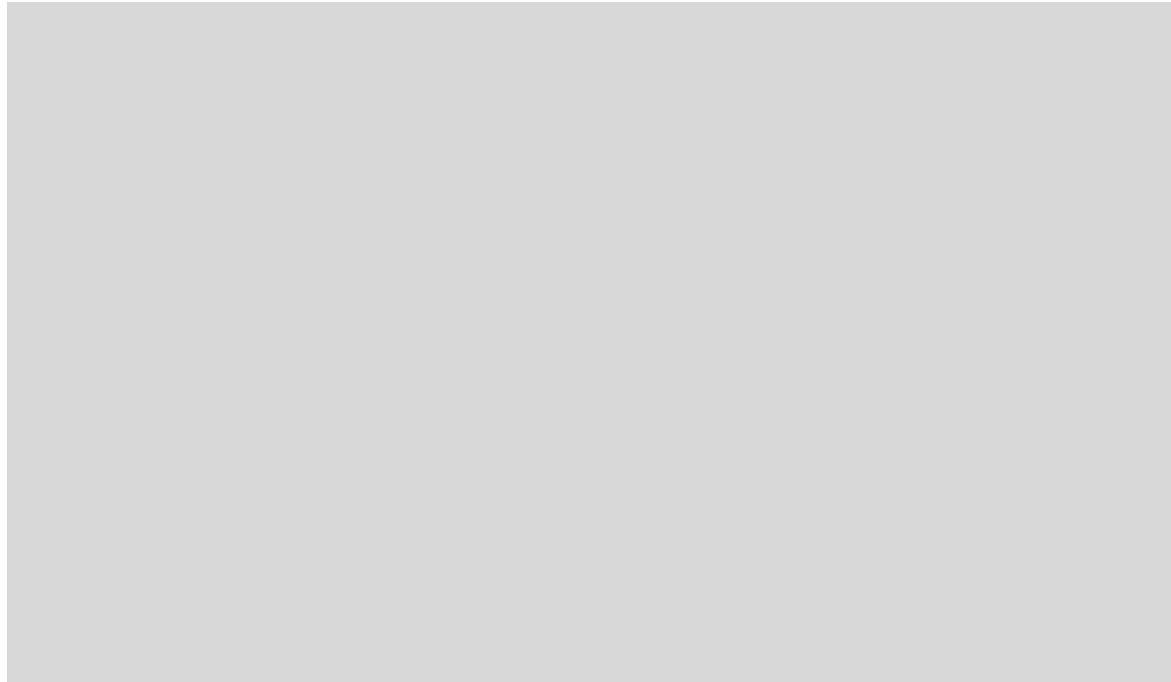
A deep link remembers the selected environment for that course launch.

If a user opens a deep link to Standard Python 3, then returns to the Noteable launcher, they may be returned to Standard Python 3 rather than shown the general launcher.

This is expected behaviour.

To use a different environment, users should return to the VLE course area and select:

- a different deep link; or
- a general Noteable launcher link, if one has been provided.



A user opens a deep-linked Noteable course activity, returns to the launcher, and is redirected to the selected environment. The recording then shows how to return to the VLE to select a general launcher link or another environment.

Appendix B: Coding-agent tools

Noteable includes command-line coding-agent tools in supported environments, including Codex, Claude and OpenCode.

These tools may be suitable for exploration, coding support, debugging and development workflows. They are not automatically configured with an AI-provider account or API key.

Before using coding agents in teaching

Course teams should confirm:

- which coding agent will be used;
- whether students need their own provider account or API key;
- whether provider usage involves charges;
- whether funding or a centrally issued key arrangement is available;
- how use of AI tools aligns with course learning outcomes and assessment requirements;
- whether students can access the required tool equitably.

Important: *Noteable provides access to coding-agent tools, but users or institutions are responsible for the required provider authentication, API access and any associated provider costs.*

For detailed guidance, see **Coding Agents in Noteable – Guidance for AY 2026/27**.

Appendix C: Assignment workflows

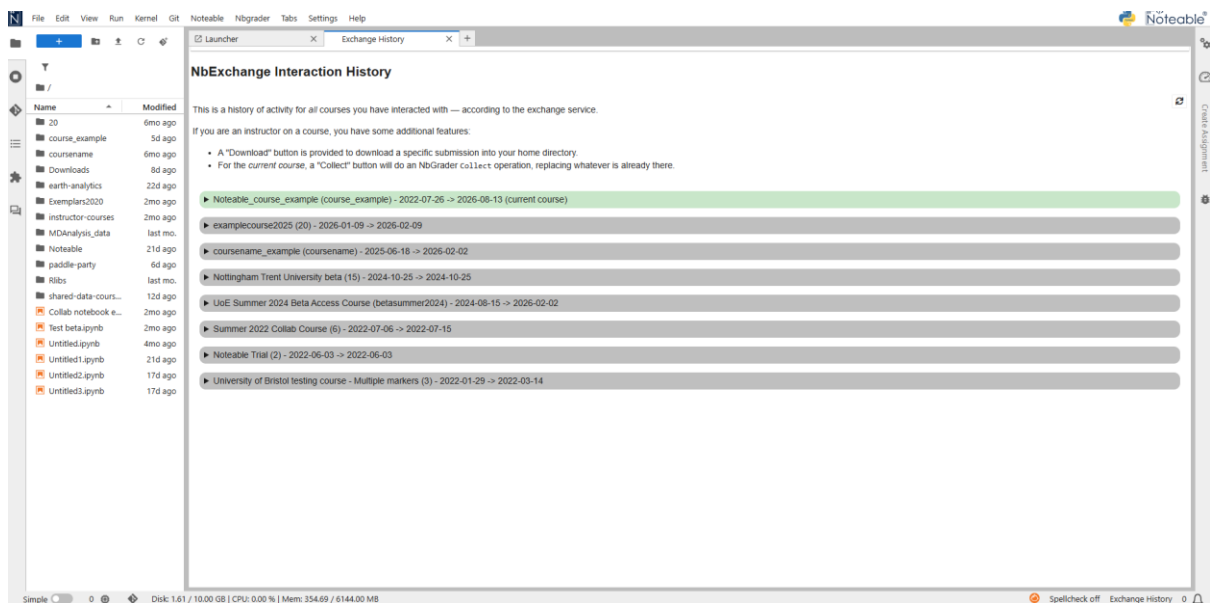
The Summer 2026 update includes Exchange History and Bulk Autograding for courses using the Noteable assignment exchange service.

Detailed instructions are available in **Noteable Assignment Workflow Updates – Guidance for AY 2026/27**.

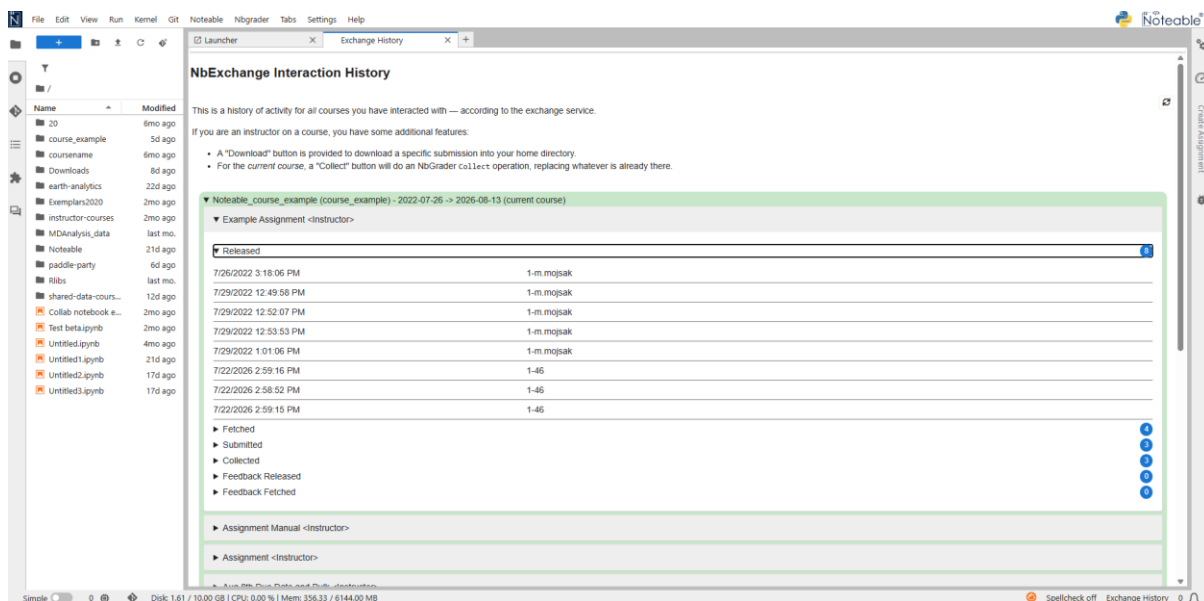
Exchange History: example uses

Instructors can use Exchange History to:

- confirm whether an assignment was released;
- check whether a student submission reached the exchange;
- review activity on a particular assignment;
- download a specific student submission;
- collect a specific submission again where a local copy needs replaced;
- review feedback-related activity.



Exchange History overview, with the current course identified



Expanded assignment/submission entry showing time-ordered activity.

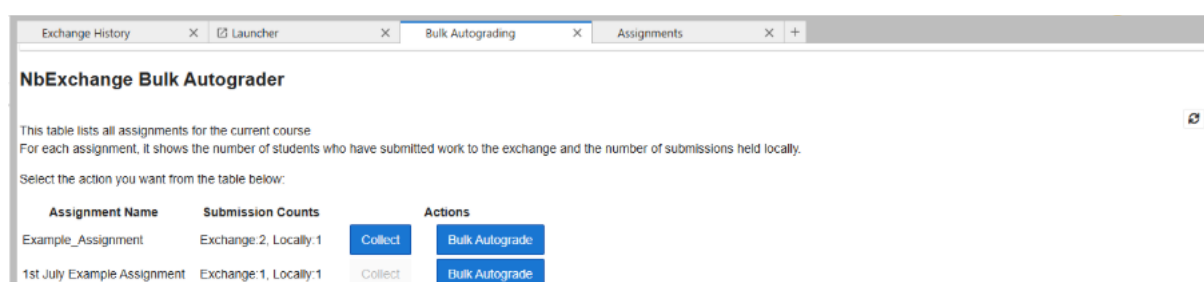
Bulk Autograding: example uses

Bulk Autograding is useful when instructors need to collect and autograde multiple submissions.

It displays:

- assignments for the current course;
- the number of submissions currently available in the exchange;
- the number already collected locally;
- **Collect** and **Bulk Autograde** actions.

The Collect option is unavailable where there are no outstanding submissions.



Bulk Autograding table, showing available and collected submission counts.